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DEMOGRAPHY AND SETTLEMENT OF LATE IMPERIAL RUSSIA (1815AD - 1917AD).

A Regional Literature Review of Population and Settlement (1815AD - 1917AD).

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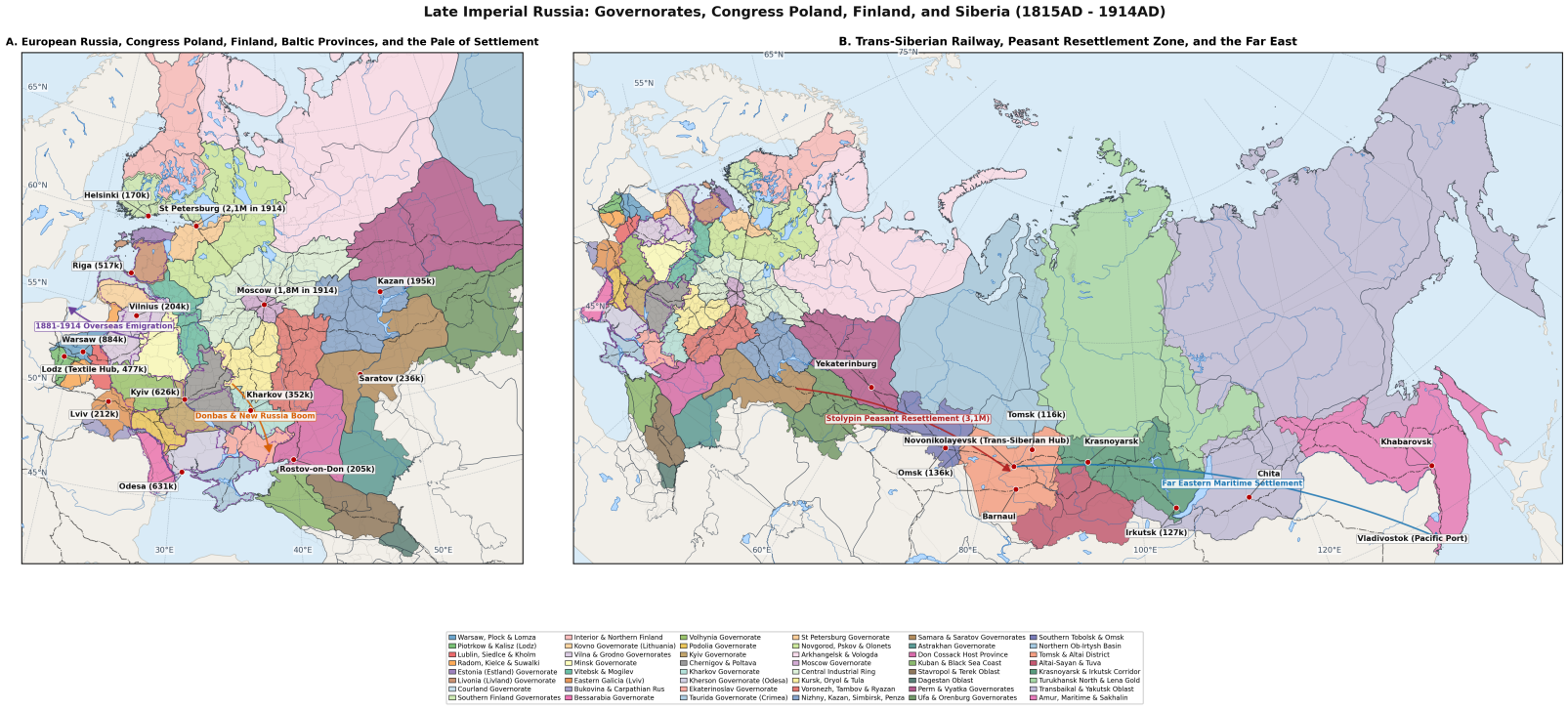


Figure 1. Governorates, oblasts, crownlands, railways and major urban centres of Late Imperial Russia and Austro-Hungarian Ukraine (1815AD - 1917AD).

Abstract

Between the Final Act of the Congress of Vienna in June 1815AD and the collapse of the Romanov monarchy in 1917AD, the population across the 48 historical Governorates (*guberniyas*), Oblasts, Finnish Provinces, Vistula Provinces and Austro-Hungarian Ukrainian Crownlands covering 18.607.231 km2 (460.079 five-arcminute grid cells, excluding Central Asia and the Southern Caucasus) nearly tripled. Total population rose from 57,87M (57,87M) in 1815AD to 67,36M (67,36M) at the Eighth Soul Revision in 1833AD, 78,34M (78,34M) at the Ninth Revision in 1850AD, 83,92M (83,92M) at the Tenth Revision in 1858AD, 94,58M (94,58M) in 1870AD, 110,35M (110,35M) in 1885AD, 123,89M (123,89M) at the First All-Russian Imperial Census of 28 January 1897AD, 156,22M (156,23M) in 1910AD and a pre-war peak of 167,94M (167,95M) on 1 January 1914AD, before First World War mobilisation, combat mortality and the 1915AD *bezhentsy* refugee evacuation lowered the regional population to 165,38M (165,38M) in 1917AD [1][2][3][4][5][6].

Background

Retrofitting post-1991AD oblast or republic boundaries onto nineteenth-century Eastern Europe and Northern Asia conceals the legal, fiscal and infrastructural boundaries that governed demographic behaviour between 1815AD and 1917AD. Six institutional divides structured the 48-region division shown in Figure 1 and tabulated in Table 1.

In the west, three autonomous polities incorporated between 1809AD and 1815AD operated under distinct agrarian laws, customs regimes and statistical offices [7][8][9][10]. These comprised the Congress Kingdom of Poland (Regions 1-4, covering all ten Vistula Governorates of Warsaw, Plock, Lomza, Piotrkow, Kalisz, Lublin, Siedlce with the 1912AD Kholm split, Radom, Kielce and Suwalki), the three German-noble Ostsee Baltic Governorates (Regions 5-7, comprising Estland, Livland and Courland, where landless peasant emancipation in 1816-1819AD initiated the Empire's earliest demographic transition) and the Grand Duchy of Finland (Regions 8-9, encompassing all eight Finnish *lan* administered by the Imperial Senate in Helsingfors).

East of the Vistula and Baltic provinces, the statutory Pale of Permanent Jewish Settlement (*Cherta postoyannoy evreyskoy osedlosti*), codified in 1835AD and tightened under the May Laws of 1882AD, restricted Jewish residence to the Northwestern Krai (Regions 10-13, covering Kovno, Vilna, Grodno, Minsk, Vitebsk and Mogilev), Bessarabia (Region 16), the Southwestern Krai (Regions 17-19, covering Volhynia, Podolia and Kyiv), Little Russia (Region 20, comprising Chernigov and Poltava) and Novorossiya (Regions 22-24, covering Kherson, Ekaterinoslav and Taurida), alongside separate civil regulations in Congress Poland [11][12][13][14]. Across the southwestern border, Habsburg-ruled Ukrainian lands were divided after the 1867AD *Ausgleich* between Austrian *Cisleithania* - comprising Eastern Galicia (Region 14, with Lemberg/Lviv, Tarnopol, Stanislau and the Boryslav oil basin) and the Duchy of Bukovina (Czernowitz) - and Hungarian *Transleithania* across the Subcarpathian Comitats of Bereg, Ung, Ugocsa and Maramaros in Region 15 [15][16][17][18].

Within the Russian interior, post-1861AD peasant land hunger (*malozemelye*) and the 1891-1892AD Volga and Black-Earth famine in Regions 20 and 30-32 contrasted sharply with the rapidly urbanising capitals of Saint Petersburg (Region 25) and Moscow (Region 28) and the coal, iron and grain boom across Kherson, Ekaterinoslav, Taurida and the Don Cossack Host in Regions 22-24 and 35 [19][20][21][22]. Along the North Caucasian frontier, Regions 36-38 separate Kuban Oblast and the Black Sea Governorate - the main theatre of the 1860-1864AD Circassian expulsion and subsequent Cossack and Slavic settlement - from Stavropol Governorate and Terek Oblast (Vladikavkaz, the Grozny oilfields and the Vainakh-Ossetian highlands) and highland Dagestan Oblast [23][24][25][26]. In Asian Russia (Regions 41-48), the dense west-to-east Trans-Siberian, Altai Cabinet and Priamurye settlement corridors (Regions 41, 43, 45 and 48, which absorbed over 3M Stolypin peasant migrants in 1906-1914AD) stood apart from the bypassed Ob-Irtysh polar river trail (Region 42), the Altai-Sayan and 1914AD Uriankhai highlands (Region 44), the Yenisei-Turukhansk and Bodaibo Lena gold basin (Region 46) and Transbaikal and Yakutsk Oblasts (Region 47) [27][28][29][30].

Region/ Governorate/ Oblast	Area (km2)	1815AD	1833AD	1858AD	1885AD	1897AD	1914AD	1917AD
1. Warsaw, Plock & Lomza Gubs.	35.957	1,02M	1,28M	1,62M	2,65M	3,54M	5,05M	4,42M
2. Piotrkow & Kalisz Gubs.	20.156	720k	940k	1,24M	1,98M	2,25M	3,32M	2,95M

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Region/ Governorate/ Oblast	Area (km2)	1815AD	1833AD	1858AD	1885AD	1897AD	1914AD	1917AD
3. Lublin & Siedlce Gubs.	27.342	780k	960k	1,18M	1,74M	1,93M	2,68M	2,08M
4. Radom, Kielce & Suwalki Gubs.	33.393	780k	950k	1,16M	1,68M	2,16M	2,6M	2,18M
5. Estland Gub.	22.637	232k	275k	312k	382k	413k	505k	515k
6. Livland Gub.	54.235	615k	735k	885k	1,18M	1,3M	1,56M	1,42M
7. Courland Gub.	27.588	418k	495k	565k	655k	674k	800k	380k
8. Southern Finland Gubs.: Nyland	114.315	590k	745k	945k	1,2M	1,42M	1,84M	1,89M
9. Interior & Northern Finland Gubs.: Vasa, Kuopio, Sankt-Michel & Uleaborg	263.819	520k	645k	815k	1,01M	1,13M	1,4M	1,43M
10. Kovno Gub.	43.910	660k	785k	965k	1,38M	1,54M	1,84M	1,32M
11. Vilna & Grodno Gubs.	85.286	1,14M	1,36M	1,65M	2,68M	3,19M	3,94M	2,88M
12. Minsk Gub. & Pripyat Polesia	91.928	920k	1,04M	1,21M	1,82M	2,15M	3,04M	2,89M
13. Vitebsk & Mogilev Gubs.	83.637	1,25M	1,41M	1,64M	2,58M	3,18M	4,02M	3,86M
14. Austro-Hungarian Eastern Galicia	46.070	2,58M	2,88M	3,36M	4,12M	4,42M	5,02M	4,45M
15. Austro-Hungarian Bukovina	24.487	770k	870k	1,03M	1,29M	1,4M	1,63M	1,5M
16. Bessarabia Gub.	47.379	385k	640k	950k	1,58M	1,94M	2,66M	2,62M
17. Volhynia Gub.	76.532	1,52M	1,68M	2,01M	2,64M	2,99M	4,12M	3,68M
18. Podolia Gub.	41.427	1,44M	1,62M	1,98M	2,65M	3,02M	3,98M	3,82M
19. Kyiv Gub.	54.181	940k	1,22M	1,78M	2,92M	3,56M	4,78M	4,84M
20. Little Russian Gubs.: Chernigov & Poltava	106.759	3,35M	3,68M	4,34M	4,88M	5,08M	6,65M	6,72M
21. Kharkov Gub.	57.378	1,1M	1,26M	1,59M	2,18M	2,49M	3,44M	3,51M
22. Kherson Gub.	75.498	620k	880k	1,38M	2,24M	2,73M	3,75M	3,78M

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Region/ Governorate/ Oblast	Area (km2)	1815AD	1833AD	1858AD	1885AD	1897AD	1914AD	1917AD
23. Ekaterinoslav Gub.	60.209	820k	1,04M	1,46M	1,92M	2,11M	3,45M	3,58M
24. Taurida Gub.	69.868	370k	520k	660k	1,08M	1,45M	2,06M	2,08M
25. Saint Petersburg Gub.	62.709	760k	940k	1,22M	1,76M	2,11M	3,15M	3,38M
26. Novgorod, Pskov & Olonets Gubs.	306.049	1,77M	1,96M	2,26M	2,68M	2,85M	3,58M	3,68M
27. Arkhangelsk & Vologda Gubs.	1.313.985	920k	1,04M	1,24M	1,54M	1,69M	2,22M	2,28M
28. Moscow Gub.	28.080	1,12M	1,32M	1,62M	2,14M	2,43M	3,56M	3,82M
29. Central Industrial Ring: Vladimir, Yaroslavl, Kostroma, Tver, Smolensk & Kaluga Gubs.	320.596	6,75M	7,25M	8,08M	8,82M	9,16M	11,52M	11,88M
30. Western Central Black-Earth Gubs.: Kursk, Oryol & Tula	116.196	4,52M	5,02M	5,88M	6,42M	6,21M	7,98M	8,18M
31. Eastern Central Black-Earth Gubs.: Voronezh, Tambov & Ryazan	163.112	5,12M	5,72M	6,76M	7,28M	7,04M	9,22M	9,45M
32. Middle Volga Gubs.: Nizhny Novgorod, Kazan, Simbirsk & Penza	196.693	4,28M	4,82M	5,72M	6,52M	6,75M	8,35M	8,55M
33. Samara & Saratov Gubs.	257.216	1,58M	2,18M	3,38M	4,68M	5,16M	6,88M	7,12M
34. Astrakhan Gub.	157.993	380k	480k	640k	880k	1M	1,38M	1,41M
35. Don Cossack Host	173.010	680k	880k	1,42M	2,12M	2,56M	3,88M	3,94M

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Region/ Governorate/ Oblast	Area (km2)	1815AD	1833AD	1858AD	1885AD	1897AD	1914AD	1917AD
36. Kuban Oblast & Black Sea Gub.	100.010	420k	480k	640k	1,38M	1,98M	3,06M	3,12M
37. Stavropol Gub. & Terek Oblast	131.162	545k	640k	860k	1,48M	1,81M	2,61M	2,65M
38. Dagestan Oblast	30.663	450k	440k	410k	530k	571k	715k	725k
39. Perm & Vyatka Gubs.	491.785	1,92M	2,38M	3,42M	5,18M	6,03M	7,88M	8,04M
40. Ufa & Orenburg Gubs.	339.132	1,4M	1,78M	2,56M	3,42M	3,8M	5,35M	5,48M
41. West Siberian Trans-Siberian Belt: Southern Tobolsk	244.121	545k	680k	990k	1,48M	1,74M	3,18M	3,32M
42. Ob-Irtysh River Trail & Polar Tundra: Tobolsk, Surgut, Berezov & Narym	1.637.985	160k	185k	240k	325k	375k	505k	520k
43. Tomsk Railway Trunk	499.967	300k	410k	690k	1,34M	1,93M	3,98M	4,18M
44. Altai-Sayan Highlands: Gorny Altai, Minusinsk & Uriankhai Protectorate	418.838	125k	150k	205k	285k	330k	565k	575k
45. Central Siberian Trans-Siberian Corridor: Achinsk-Krasnoyarsk-Kansk & Irkutsk	521.596	210k	260k	375k	610k	795k	1,54M	1,56M
46. Yenisei-Turukhansk Polar North & Bodaibo Lena Goldfields	2.480.545	68k	80k	110k	165k	195k	270k	265k
47. Transbaikal Oblast	6.008.677	278k	320k	415k	680k	942k	1,29M	1,3M

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Region/ Governorate/ Oblast	Area (km2)	1815AD	1833AD	1858AD	1885AD	1897AD	1914AD	1917AD
48. Priamurye Gov.-Gen.: Amur, Primorskaya	1.043.120	30k	35k	55k	195k	372k	1,14M	1,15M
Total (All 48 Regions)	18.607.231	57,87M	67,36M	83,92M	110,35M	123,89M	167,94M	165,38M

Table 1. Regional population series and land areas across all 48 governorates, oblasts and crownlands (1815AD - 1917AD).

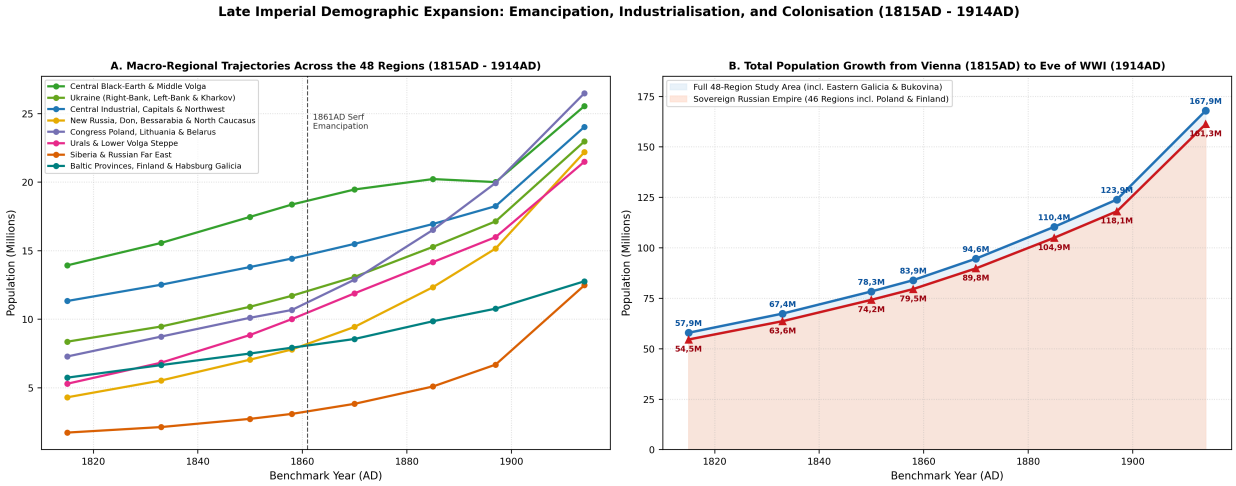


Figure 2. Macro-regional population trajectories in millions (Panel A) and indexed growth relative to 1815AD = 100 across Late Imperial Russia (Panel B).

Methodology

Reconstructing provincial populations across this 102-year period draws on seven archival and statistical series, summarised across all ten benchmark dates in Table 2.

For the pre-emancipation decades, our figures rest on the final four Soul Revisions (*revizii*, VII-X, 1815AD-1858AD). Following the Seventh Revision (1815-1816AD), which recorded Napoleonic wartime losses across western and central provinces, Imperial fiscal commissions conducted the Eighth (1833-1835AD), Ninth (1850AD) and Tenth (1857-1858AD) Soul Revisions [1][31][32]. Unlike the male-only Sixth Revision of 1811AD, Revisions VII-X registered both sexes of the tax-bearing estates (*podatnye sosloviya*). Following V. M. Kabuzan (1971AD, 1992AD) and A. G. Troinitsky (1861AD), raw revision returns are supplemented with Governorate statistical committee (*gubernskie statisticheskie komitety*) police registers for tax-exempt nobles, clergy, civil servants, regular military forces and Cossack hosts [2][22][33].

After emancipation, administrative tracking passed to the Central Statistical Committee (*Tsentralnyy Statisticheskiy Komitet*, TsSK MVD) for 1863AD-1914AD. Established within the Ministry of Internal Affairs

in 1858-1863AD under P. P. Semenov, the committee published periodic compilations (*Statisticheskiy vremennik Rossiyskoy imperii*) and, from 1904AD to 1915AD, annual yearbooks (*Statisticheskiy ezhegodnik Rossii*), combining Orthodox synodal, Lutheran, Catholic, Jewish and Muslim vital registration with *zemstvo* household censuses (*podvornye perepisi*) [3][5][34].

The late nineteenth-century series is anchored by the First All-Russian General Census of 28 January 1897AD. Directed by Semenov-Tyan-Shansky and edited by N. A. Troinitsky across 89 provincial volumes (1899-1905AD), the 1897AD Census enumerated 125.640.021 *de facto* residents across the Empire excluding Finland [4][35]. Across our 46 Russian, Polish, Baltic, Siberian and Finnish regions, the 1897AD benchmark totals 118,06M (115,51M across the 44 Imperial and Vistula regions - matching the 1897AD Census guberniya totals minus the 10,13M inhabitants of Transcaucasia and Central Asia outside the study area - plus 2,56M in the Grand Duchy of Finland), which together with 5,82M in Austro-Hungarian Galicia, Bukovina and Subcarpathia yields the 48-region 1897AD total of 123,89M [4][15][36].

In the western borderlands, separate statistical offices maintained independent demographic records. Because the Grand Duchy of Finland retained Swedish-era Lutheran parish population registers (*kirkonkirjat* and *vaestotaulut* initiated in 1749AD) and established its own Central Statistical Office (*Tilastollinen paatoimisto*) in 1865AD, Regions 8-9 possess continuous quinquennial and decennial *de jure* and *de facto* series from 1815AD to 1910AD (1,11M in 1815AD, 1,76M in 1858AD, 1,77M in 1870AD following the 1866-1868AD famine, 2,56M in 1897AD and 3,05M in 1910AD) [36][37]. For the ten Vistula Governorates (*Privislinskie gubernii*, Regions 1-4), civil registry books introduced under the Napoleonic Code in 1808AD and the 40 volumes of *Trudy Varshavskogo statisticheskogo komiteta* published by the Warsaw Statistical Committee (1888AD-1914AD) reconcile permanent (*postoyannoe*) and non-permanent industrial migrant (*nepostoyannoe*) urban populations in Warsaw, Lodz and Sosnowiec alongside the 1897AD Census (9,87M in 1897AD; 13,65M on 1 January 1914AD) [7][38][39].

Across the Habsburg frontier, Regions 14-15 are anchored prior to 1857AD by Josephinian military conscription rolls and from 1869AD to 1910AD by the decennial censuses (*Volkszahlung* and *Nepszamlalas*) of the *k.k. Statistische Zentralkommission* in Vienna (1880, 1890, 1900 and 1910AD) for Eastern Galicia and Bukovina and the *Magyar Kiralyi Kozponti Statisztikai Hivatal* in Budapest for Subcarpathia [15][16]. Finally, following abortive preparations for a Second Imperial Census in 1915AD [40], the Ministry of Agriculture and the Provisional Government conducted the 1916AD and 1917AD All-Russian Agricultural, Land and Urban Censuses [41][42]. Combined with the registration rolls of the Tatiana Committee and *Zemgor* analysed by Peter Gatrell (1999AD), these returns quantify the displacement of over 6M wartime refugees (*bezhentsy*) by early 1917AD [6][43].

Benchmark & Archive Source	Poland (1-4)	Balt.-Fin. (5-9)	Pale-Bess. (10-19*)	Habsb. (14-15)	Ukraine-Cauc. (20-24,36-38)	Heartland-Ural (25-35,39-40)	Siberia-FE (41-48)	Total (48 Regs)
1815AD (Revision VII/ Vienna Act)	3,3M	2,38M	8,26M	3,35M	7,67M	31,2M	1,72M	57,87M
1833AD (Revision VIII/ Parish)	4,13M	2,9M	9,76M	3,75M	8,94M	35,77M	2,12M	67,36M
1850AD (Revision IX/ Conscript)	4,91M	3,34M	11,35M	4,15M	10,56M	41,32M	2,72M	78,34M

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Benchmark & Archive Source	Poland (1-4)	Balt.-Fin. (5-9)	Pale-Bess. (10-19*)	Habsb. (14-15)	Ukraine-Cauc. (20-24,36-38)	Heartland-Ural (25-35,39-40)	Siberia-FE (41-48)	Total (48 Regs)
1858AD (Revision X/ 1857 Habsb.)	5,2M	3,52M	12,19M	4,39M	11,34M	44,2M	3,08M	83,92M
1870AD (TsSK/ 1869 A-H/Fin.)	6,34M	3,73M	14,34M	4,82M	13,03M	48,51M	3,81M	94,58M
1885AD (TsSK/ Zemstvo/VSK)	8,05M	4,43M	18,25M	5,41M	15,69M	53,44M	5,08M	110,35M
1897AD (1st Imperial Census)	9,87M	4,94M	21,57M	5,82M	18,22M	56,79M	6,68M	123,89M
1910AD (TsSK/ 1910 A-H & Fin.)	12,67M	5,77M	26,74M	6,45M	23,74M	70,03M	10,82M	156,22M
1914AD (TsSK/ VSK Pre-WWI Peak)	13,65M	6,11M	28,38M	6,65M	25,73M	74,95M	12,47M	167,94M
1917AD (Ag.-Urban Census/WWI)	11,63M	5,63M	25,91M	5,95M	26,16M	77,21M	12,88M	165,38M

Table 2. Ten-benchmark population series across the seven regional groupings of Late Imperial Russia (1815AD - 1917AD).

Results

Congress Poland, the Baltic Provinces and Finland

Congress Poland

Created at the Congress of Vienna in 1815AD out of the Napoleonic Duchy of Warsaw and reorganised into ten Vistula Governorates in 1867AD, Congress Poland (116.848 km2 across Regions 1-4) experienced the most rapid demographic densification of any western territory in the Empire, growing more than fourfold from 3,3M in 1815AD (28,2 per km2) to 5,2M in 1858AD, 9,87M in 1897AD and 13,65M in 1914AD (116,8 per km2) [7][38]. Whereas the November (1830-1831AD) and January (1863-1864AD) Uprisings inflicted short-term wartime casualties, confiscations and Siberian deportations, Tsar Alexander II's Polish Emancipation Ukase of 2 March 1864AD granted freehold title to Polish, Ukrainian and Lithuanian peasants without direct redemption payments to landlords, unleashing high rural natural increase (1,6-1,9% per year) [2][44].

Simultaneously, the abolition of the Russo-Polish customs barrier (1851AD), the completion of the Warsaw-Vienna (1848AD) and Warsaw-Saint Petersburg (1862AD) railways and the 1877AD Imperial gold tariff turned Congress Poland into the premier textile and coal-metallurgical workshop for the Russian

market [7][39][45].

In northern Mazovia, the Warsaw, Plock and Lomza governorates (Region 1) rose from 1,02M (1815AD) to 3,54M (1897AD) and 5,05M (1914AD), anchored by Warsaw, the Empire's third metropolis (0k in 1815AD to 162,8k in 1858AD to 683,7k in 1897AD to 884,5k in 1914AD, 36,9% Jewish in 1914AD), alongside the Zyrardow linen complex (6k) and the Vistula river ports of Wloclawek (4k) and Plock (2k) [7][38]. To the southwest, the Piotrkow and Kalisz governorates (Region 2) surged nearly fivefold from 720k (1815AD) to 2,25M (1897AD) and 3,32M (1914AD). Designated a factory settlement in 1820AD when it held fewer than 800 inhabitants, Lodz expanded to 29,5k (1858AD), 314k (1897AD) and 477,9k (1914AD, or over 550k with its satellite mill suburbs of Pabianice and Zgierz), while the Dabrowa Basin along the Silesian border transformed fishing and mining hamlets into Sosnowiec (5k in 1914AD, chartered only in 1902AD), Czestochowa (9k) and Bendzin (8k) [39][45].

East of the Vistula and across the southern uplands, the Lublin and Siedlce governorates (Region 3) and the Radom, Kielce and Suwalki governorates (Region 4) grew from 780k each in 1815AD to 2,68M and 2,6M in 1914AD, despite heavy peasant overseas emigration from Suwalki and Kalisz during the 1890-1913AD Brazilian emigration wave and the North American steamship boom [46]. In June 1912AD, Saint Petersburg detached the eastern Ukrainian-Uniate *uezds* of Lublin and Siedlce to form Kholm Governorate (Chelm, 24,6k) directly subordinated to Kiev [43]. During the German-Austrian offensive of summer 1915AD, Russian military scorched-earth orders triggered the *biezenstwo* (Great Retreat), evacuating over 2M residents eastward and reducing Regions 1-4 from 13,65M (1914AD) to 11,63M (1917AD), with Region 3 losing -22,4% (2,68M to 2,08M) and Kalisz shelled to ruins in August 1914AD (4k to 29k) [6][43].

The Baltic Governorates

In Estland (Region 5), Livland (Region 6) and Courland (Region 7), Alexander I's peasant emancipation acts of 1816AD (Estland), 1817AD (Courland) and 1819AD (Livland) abolished serfdom four decades before inner Russia while leaving arable land in the hands of Baltic German baronial manors (*Ritterschaften*) until mid-century tenant-purchase reforms (1849-1860s) [9][47]. Combined with near-universal Lutheran catechism literacy (92-96% adult literacy in 1897AD versus 21% Empire-wide) and a West European late-marriage pattern (*Hajnal* line), the three Baltic provinces pioneered the first sustained marital fertility transition in the Russian Empire, with Princeton European Fertility Project indices (*Ig*) falling by more than 10% across Estland, Livland and Courland between the 1860s and 1880s - forty to fifty years ahead of Central Russia [8][9][48].

Consequently, natural growth across Regions 5-7 was moderate (1,26M in 1815AD to 1,76M in 1858AD, 2,39M in 1897AD and 2,87M in 1914AD), whereas urban and industrial concentration was rapid. Riga (Region 6) grew from 36k (1815AD) to 282,2k (1897AD) and 517,5k (1914AD) as the Empire's leading timber-export port and rubber, chemical, electrotechnical and railcar manufacturing centre (Provodnik and Russo-Balt). In Estland (Region 5), Reval/Tallinn expanded to 137,6k (1914AD) and 159k (1917AD) around Peter the Great's Naval Fortress shipyards, while Dorpat/Tartu (48,6k) anchored Baltic university life. In Courland (Region 7), Libau/Liepaja (90,7k in 1914AD) served as the ice-free home port of the Russian American Line, dispatching 40k-70k Pale and Baltic emigrants annually to New York [13][47]. In spring-summer 1915AD, the German *Niemen Army* occupied Courland (Region 7), driving half its population into interior Russia (800k in 1914AD to 380k in 1917AD, -52,5%), while the evacuation of Riga's machinery and over 300k factory workers and families halved Riga to 210k and lowered Livland (Region 6) from 1,56M to 1,42M [6].

The Grand Duchy of Finland

Autonomous since the Diet of Porvoo (1809AD) and enlarged by the reincorporation of Old Finland (Viipuri/Vyborg Governorate) in 1812AD, the Grand Duchy of Finland (378.134 km2 across Regions 8-9) expanded steadily from 1,11M in 1815AD (590k in coastal/southern Region 8; 520k in interior/northern Region 9) to 1,76M in 1858AD [36][49]. This pre-industrial trajectory suffered Europe's last major peacetime famine during the Finnish Great Hunger Years (*Suuret nalkavuodet*, 1866-1868AD). Following wet summers and a severe early September frost in 1867AD that destroyed rye and barley harvests across Ostrobothnia, Savo and Kainuu while Senate Finance Head J. V. Snellman prioritised defence of the newly introduced silver *markka*, winter destitution, vagrant relief crowding and epidemic typhus, dysentery and relapsing fever killed ~150k people (~8% of Finland's population, pushing national crude death rates to 77,6 per 1.000 in 1868AD) [10][37][50][51]. In our series, Region 9 (Vasa, Kuopio, Sankt-Michel and Uleaborg) falls from 815k (1858AD) to 805k (1870AD), while Region 8 (Nyland, Abo-Bjorneborg, Tavastehus and Vyborg) stagnates (945k to 965k).

After 1870AD, completion of the Riihimaki-Saint Petersburg Railway (1870AD), dairy specialisation and steam-sawmill, pulp and paper industrialisation propelled Finland from 1,77M (1870AD) to 2,56M (1897AD), 3,24M (1914AD) and 3,32M (1917AD, spared frontline combat before 1918AD), led by Helsingfors/Helsinki (4,8k in 1815AD to 84,5k in 1897AD to 187,5k in 1917AD), Abo/Turku (54,6k), Tammerfors/Tampere (45,2k) and Viipuri/Vyborg (29,3k), even as ~300k rural Finns (above all from Vasa Governorate in Region 9) emigrated to North America between 1880AD and 1914AD [36][49].

Region (1-9)	1815AD	1850AD	1858AD	1870AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
1. Warsaw, Plock & Lomza Gubs.	1,02M	1,52M	1,62M	1,98M	3,54M	4,68M	5,05M	4,42M
2. Piotrkow & Kalisz Gubs.	720k	1,16M	1,24M	1,56M	2,25M	3,05M	3,32M	2,95M
3. Lublin & Siedlce Gubs.	780k	1,12M	1,18M	1,42M	1,93M	2,48M	2,68M	2,08M
4. Radom, Kielce & Suwalki Gubs.	780k	1,11M	1,16M	1,38M	2,16M	2,46M	2,6M	2,18M
5. Estland Gub.	232k	302k	312k	338k	413k	475k	505k	515k
6. Livland Gub.	615k	835k	885k	1M	1,3M	1,48M	1,56M	1,42M
7. Courland Gub.	418k	545k	565k	615k	674k	765k	800k	380k
8. Southern Finland Gubs.: Nyland	590k	890k	945k	965k	1,42M	1,72M	1,84M	1,89M
9. Interior & Northern Finland Gubs.: Vasa, Kuopio, Sankt-Michel & Uleaborg	520k	765k	815k	805k	1,13M	1,33M	1,4M	1,43M

Table 3. Population trajectories across Congress Poland, the Baltic governorates and the Grand Duchy of Finland (1815AD - 1917AD).

The Pale of Settlement, Bessarabia and Austro-Hungarian Ukraine

Lithuania and Belarus

Across the Lithuanian and Belarusian governorates of the Northwestern Krai (304.761 km2, Regions 10-13), total population expanded from 3,97M in 1815AD to 5,46M in 1858AD, 10,06M in 1897AD and 12,84M in 1914AD [2][4][52][53].

In ethnic Samogitia and Lithuania, Kovno Governorate (Region 10, created in 1843AD) grew from 660k (1815AD) to 1,54M (1897AD) and 1,84M (1914AD). Intense post-1863AD Russification (including the 1864-1904AD Latin-press ban), a lack of heavy industry outside Kovno/Kaunas (9k to 91,4k) and Shavli/Siauliai (5k) and early peasant parcellation triggered substantial transatlantic emigration (~250k-300k ethnic Lithuanians and Litvak Jews to Pennsylvania coal mines, Chicago, Scotland and South America in 1880-1914AD) before the 1915AD German *Ober Ost* occupation cut Kovno's population by -28,3% to 1,32M in 1917AD [6][13][54].

Farther south and east, the Vilna and Grodno governorates (Region 11, rising from 1,15M to 3,19M in 1897AD and 3,94M in 1914AD), Minsk Governorate and Pripyat Polesia (Region 12, 920k to 2,15M to 3,04M) and the Vitebsk and Mogilev governorates including the Catholic Latgalian *uezds* of Dvinsk, Rezhitsa and Lyutsin (Region 13, 1,25M to 3,18M to 4,02M) formed the *shtetl* (*mestechko*) heartland of the Pale [11][14][55]. After Alexander III's May Laws of 3 May 1882AD barred new Jewish rural residence and leases, Jewish populations (8-17,5% provincial shares) exceeded 50-65% inside Vilna (5k to 204,3k), the Bialystok woollen-textile boomtown (0k to 91,5k, site of the June 1906AD pogrom), Dvinsk/Daugavpils (7k to 112,8k), Minsk (9k to 117,6k), Vitebsk (9k to 108,9k), Gomel (8k to 104,5k), Grodno (9k to 61,6k) and Brest-Litovsk (6k to 57,4k, burned and evacuated to 16,5k in August 1915AD) [13][56]. Between 1906AD and 1914AD, overcrowded Belarusian villages in Mogilev, Vitebsk and Minsk also sent over 340k peasant settlers to Siberia [57], while the 1915AD front line split Region 11 (3,94M to 2,88M, -26,9%) from rear-echelon Stavka headquarters at Mogilev [6].

Bessarabia and the Southwestern Krai

Annexed from the Ottoman Principality of Moldavia by the Treaty of Bucharest (1812AD), Bessarabia Governorate (Region 16, 47.379 km2) expanded nearly sevenfold from 385k in 1815AD to 950k in 1858AD, 1,94M in 1897AD and 2,66M in 1914AD (2,62M in 1917AD), propelled by state-sponsored Bulgarian, Gagauz, German, Ukrainian and Russian settlement across the southern Budjak steppe alongside a Moldovan rural majority and fast-growing Kishinev/Chisinau (14,5k to 108,5k in 1897AD to 128,7k in 1914AD), Bender (31,8k), Akkerman (28,3k) and Ismail (22,3k) [4][58][59]. Southern Bessarabia (Cahul, Bolgrad and Ismail uezds) was ceded to Moldavia/Romania under the 1856AD Treaty of Paris and re-annexed by Russia at the 1878AD Congress of Berlin; in April 1903AD, the Kishinev Pogrom (49 killed), followed by the October 1905AD pogrom wave (Odessa, Kyiv and Bialystok), triggered the peak 1903-1914AD surge of Russian-Jewish transatlantic emigration (~1,25M arrivals in the United States in 1903-1914AD out of ~2M total Pale emigrants in 1881-1914AD) [12][13][60].

In the Southwestern Krai (Regions 17-19, covering Volhynia, Podolia and Kyiv Governorates), abolition of Polish noble autonomy after 1831/1863AD and capital-intensive sugar-beet agro-industrialisation (accounting for over 80% of Imperial refined sugar output under the Brodsky, Tereshchenko and Bobrinsky estates) supported Europe's densest black-earth rural populations [61][62]. Volhynia (Region 17) grew from 1,52M (1815AD) to 2,99M (1897AD) and 4,12M (1914AD) before 1915-1916AD Southwestern Front combat and the Russian Army's deportation of ~150k Volhynian Germans and border Jews lowered it to 3,68M (1917AD). Podolia (Region 18) rose from 1,44M to 3,02M (1897AD, 72,8 per km2) and 3,98M (1914AD), while Kyiv Governorate (Region 19) quintupled from 940k (1815AD) to 3,56M (1897AD) and

4,78M (1914AD, rising to 4,84M in 1917AD with wartime rear-area inflows), led by Kyiv (23,5k in 1815AD to 247,7k in 1897AD to 626,3k in 1914AD) [4][6].

Galicia, Bukovina and Subcarpathian Rus

Across the Habsburg border, imperial abolition of *Robota* labour obligations during the Revolutions of 1848AD emancipated Ukrainian (*Ruthenian*) smallholders in Eastern Galicia (Region 14, growing from 2,58M in 1815AD to 3,36M in 1858AD, 4,42M in 1897AD and 5,02M in 1914AD) and Bukovina and Hungarian Subcarpathian Rus (Region 15, rising from 770k to 1,03M, 1,4M and 1,63M) [15][16][17]. Despite the turn-of-the-century Boryslav-Drohobych petroleum boom (Drohobych 36,5k and Boryslav 16,8k, making Galicia the world's third-largest oil producer in 1909AD) and the growth of Lemberg/Lviv (44,5k to 212k) and Czernowitz/Chernivtsi (7,2k to 94k) [18][63], extreme dwarf-plot subdivision (>80% of peasant holdings under 5 ha) drove over 400k Galician, Bukovinian and Transcarpathian Ukrainians and Jews to homestead in Western Canada (Manitoba, Saskatchewan and Alberta) or enter American industrial towns between 1885AD and 1914AD. Between August 1914AD and 1917AD, four sweeping Russo-Austrian offensives across Galicia and the Carpathian passes, Austro-Hungarian military executions and internment of suspected Russophiles at Thalerhof (Graz) and Russian occupation deportations reduced Region 14 from 5,02M to 4,45M (-11,4%) and Region 15 from 1,63M to 1,5M (-8%) [6].

Region (10-19)	1815AD	1850AD	1870AD	1885AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
10. Kovno Gub.	660k	915k	1,12M	1,38M	1,54M	1,76M	1,84M	1,32M
11. Vilna & Grodno Gubs.	1,14M	1,56M	2,02M	2,68M	3,19M	3,78M	3,94M	2,88M
12. Minsk Gub. & Pripyat Polesia	920k	1,15M	1,42M	1,82M	2,15M	2,82M	3,04M	2,89M
13. Vitebsk & Mogilev Gubs.	1,25M	1,56M	1,98M	2,58M	3,18M	3,82M	4,02M	3,86M
14. Austro-Hungarian Eastern Galicia	2,58M	3,18M	3,68M	4,12M	4,42M	4,88M	5,02M	4,45M
15. Austro-Hungarian Bukovina	770k	970k	1,14M	1,29M	1,4M	1,57M	1,63M	1,5M
16. Bessarabia Gub.	385k	860k	1,16M	1,58M	1,94M	2,48M	2,66M	2,62M
17. Volhynia Gub.	1,52M	1,88M	2,24M	2,64M	2,99M	3,82M	4,12M	3,68M
18. Podolia Gub.	1,44M	1,84M	2,22M	2,65M	3,02M	3,74M	3,98M	3,82M
19. Kyiv Gub.	940k	1,58M	2,18M	2,92M	3,56M	4,52M	4,78M	4,84M

Table 4. Population series across Lithuania, Belarus, Austro-Hungarian Ukraine, Bessarabia and Right-Bank Ukraine (1815AD - 1917AD).

Novorossiya, the Russian Heartland and the North Caucasus

Left-Bank Ukraine, New Russia and the Russian Heartland

Across the southern Ukrainian and Pontic-Azov steppes, demographic growth combined agrarian colonisation with late-Imperial heavy industrialisation.

In Left-Bank *Malorossiya* and Sloboda Ukraine (Regions 20-21), Chernigov and Poltava (Region 20, rising from 3,35M to 5,08M in 1897AD and 6,65M in 1914AD) suffered acute post-1861AD allotment shrinkage and became the Empire's largest peasant donor zone to Siberia and the Far East [27], whereas Kharkov

Governorate (Region 21, 1,1M to 2,49M to 3,44M) boomed around Kharkov (8k to 174k to 258k), locomotive works and southern rail administration [62][64]. Farther south across Novorossiya and the Don Cossack Host (Regions 22-24 and 35), the Crimean War (1853-1856AD) in Taurida Governorate (Region 24) besieged and depopulated Sevastopol (0k in 1833AD to 11,2k in 1858AD) and triggered the 1860-1862AD Crimean Tatar and Nogai exodus (~180k-200k *muhajirs* emigrating to the Ottoman Empire, flattening Region 24 from 640k in 1850AD to 660k in 1858AD), before mainland Tavria grain farming and naval reconstruction lifted Taurida to 1,45M (1897AD) and 2,06M (1914AD) [40][65][66]. To the north and west, Kherson Governorate (Region 22, 620k to 2,73M to 3,75M, led by grain-export metropolis Odessa at 35k to 403,8k to 630k and shipyard Nikolaev at 108,8k) [21][67], Ekaterinoslav Governorate (Region 23, 820k to 2,11M to 3,45M) and the Don Cossack Host (Region 35, 680k to 2,56M to 3,88M, led by Rostov-on-Don at 204,8k and Taganrog at 78,6k) experienced Europe's fastest heavy-industrial transformation after the Catherine Railway (1884AD) linked Krivoy Rog hematite iron ore with Donbas coking coal around John Hughes's Yuzovka/Donetsk (9k in 1870AD to 28,1k in 1897AD to 54k in 1914AD), Ekaterinoslav (4k), Lugansk (0k) and Mariupol (0k) [20][68][69][70][71][72].

In the northern and central Russian heartland (Regions 25-34 and 39-40), Saint Petersburg Governorate (Region 25, rising from 760k to 2,11M, 3,15M in 1914AD and 3,38M in 1917AD, with the city growing from 2,12M to 2,3M under wartime Putilov munitions expansion) and Moscow Governorate (Region 28, 1,12M to 2,43M to 3,56M and 3,82M, with the city reaching 1,76M to 1,85M) absorbed millions of peasant *otkhodniki* from Novgorod-Pskov-Olonets (Region 26), Arkhangelsk-Vologda (Region 27, where Romanov-on-Murman/Murmansk was founded at the terminus of the Murman Railway in 1916AD) and the Central Industrial Ring (Region 29, 6,75M to 11,52M, including textile boomtown Ivanovo-Voznesensk at 146k) [3][73][74]. By contrast, the Central Black-Earth provinces (Regions 30-31) and the Middle and Lower Volga (Regions 32-34) suffered recurrent Malthusian and epidemic shocks. Following severe autumn-spring drought across seventeen chernozem and Volga provinces, the 1891-1892AD Famine and Cholera Pandemic caused ~400k-500k excess deaths (compounded by typhus and the 1892AD Caspian-Volga cholera wave striking Astrakhan, Saratov, Samara, Simbirsk, Kazan, Voronezh and Tambov) [19][75][76][77]. Combined with accelerating peasant out-migration, net population in the Western Black-Earth provinces (Region 30, covering Kursk, Oryol and Tula) and the Eastern Black-Earth provinces (Region 31, covering Voronezh, Tambov and Ryazan) contracted between 1885AD and the 1897AD Census (6,42M to 6,21M and 7,28M to 7,04M) before recovering to 7,98M and 9,22M by 1914AD [78][79][80]. Farther east, Samara and Saratov (Region 33, 1,58M to 5,16M to 6,88M, home to >400k Volga Germans and the grain ports of Saratov at 235,9k, Samara at 143,8k and Tsaritsyn at 101k), Perm and Vyatka (Region 39, 1,92M to 6,03M to 7,88M, with Ekaterinburg at 70k and the Izhevsk arsenal) and Ufa and Orenburg (Region 40, 1,4M to 3,8M to 5,35M, including the Trans-Siberian migration gateway of Chelyabinsk at 70,5k) sustained rapid agricultural and industrial settlement [81][82][83][84].

The North Caucasus

Across the North Caucasus (261.835 km2, Regions 36-38), nineteenth-century demographic history was shaped by the Caucasian War (1817-1864AD). In the east, three decades of mountain warfare against Imam Shamil's Caucasian Imamate (1829-1859AD, ending at Gunib) depressed Dagestan Oblast (Region 38) from 450k (1815AD) to 410k (1858AD) before railway-port links through Petrovsk-Port/Makhachkala (24,8k) and Derbent (32,7k) restored growth to 571k (1897AD) and 715k (1914AD) [24][26][85]. In the northwest, the final conquest of Circassia (1860-1864AD, culminating at Kbaada in May 1864AD) entailed the expulsion and Black Sea embarkation mortality of ~500k-650k+ Circassians (Adyghe), Ubykhs and Abazas (*muhajirstvo*) to the Ottoman Empire [23][25]. Immediately thereafter, land grants to Kuban Cossacks and land-hungry Ukrainian and Russian *inogorodnie* peasants propelled Kuban Oblast and the Black Sea Governorate (Region 36) nearly fivefold from 640k (1858AD) to 1,98M (1897AD) and 3,06M (1914AD,

anchored by Ekaterinodar at 107,1k and the cement-grain port of Novorossiysk at 66,7k), while Stavropol and Terek (Region 37) surged from 860k (1858AD) to 1,81M (1897AD) and 2,61M (1914AD), driven by Vladikavkaz (79,3k) and the Grozny petroleum boom (15,6k to 38,2k to 45k in 1917AD) [86][87][88].

Region (20-40)	1815AD	1850AD	1870AD	1885AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
20. Little Russian Gubs.: Chernigov & Poltava	3,35M	4,12M	4,62M	4,88M	5,08M	6,28M	6,65M	6,72M
21. Kharkov Gub.	1,1M	1,48M	1,82M	2,18M	2,49M	3,22M	3,44M	3,51M
22. Kherson Gub.	620k	1,22M	1,68M	2,24M	2,73M	3,48M	3,75M	3,78M
23. Ekaterinoslav Gub.	820k	1,32M	1,68M	1,92M	2,11M	3,06M	3,45M	3,58M
24. Taurida Gub.	370k	640k	780k	1,08M	1,45M	1,88M	2,06M	2,08M
25. Saint Petersburg Gub.	760k	1,12M	1,42M	1,76M	2,11M	2,86M	3,15M	3,38M
26. Novgorod, Pskov & Olonets Gubs.	1,77M	2,16M	2,44M	2,68M	2,85M	3,38M	3,58M	3,68M
27. Arkhangelsk & Vologda Gubs.	920k	1,18M	1,36M	1,54M	1,69M	2,08M	2,22M	2,28M
28. Moscow Gub.	1,12M	1,52M	1,82M	2,14M	2,43M	3,22M	3,56M	3,82M
29. Central Industrial Ring: Vladimir, Yaroslavl, Kostroma, Tver, Smolensk & Kaluga Gubs.	6,75M	7,82M	8,45M	8,82M	9,16M	10,85M	11,52M	11,88M
30. Western Central Black-Earth Gubs.: Kursk, Oryol & Tula	4,52M	5,62M	6,22M	6,42M	6,21M	7,52M	7,98M	8,18M
31. Eastern Central Black-Earth Gubs.: Voronezh, Tambov & Ryazan	5,12M	6,42M	7,12M	7,28M	7,04M	8,68M	9,22M	9,45M
32. Middle Volga Gubs.: Nizhny Novgorod, Kazan, Simbirsk & Penza	4,28M	5,42M	6,12M	6,52M	6,75M	7,92M	8,35M	8,55M
33. Samara & Saratov Gubs.	1,58M	2,96M	3,98M	4,68M	5,16M	6,42M	6,88M	7,12M
34. Astrakhan Gub.	380k	580k	740k	880k	1M	1,28M	1,38M	1,41M
35. Don Cossack Host	680k	1,22M	1,68M	2,12M	2,56M	3,52M	3,88M	3,94M
36. Kuban Oblast & Black Sea Gub.	420k	580k	860k	1,38M	1,98M	2,76M	3,06M	3,12M
37. Stavropol Gub. & Terek Oblast	545k	780k	1,12M	1,48M	1,81M	2,38M	2,61M	2,65M
38. Dagestan Oblast	450k	420k	470k	530k	571k	680k	715k	725k
39. Perm & Vyatka Gubs.	1,92M	3,02M	4,18M	5,18M	6,03M	7,38M	7,88M	8,04M
40. Ufa & Orenburg Gubs.	1,4M	2,28M	2,98M	3,42M	3,8M	4,92M	5,35M	5,48M

Table 5. Population series across Left-Bank and Southern Ukraine, European Russia, the Volga, the North Caucasus and the Urals (1815AD - 1917AD).

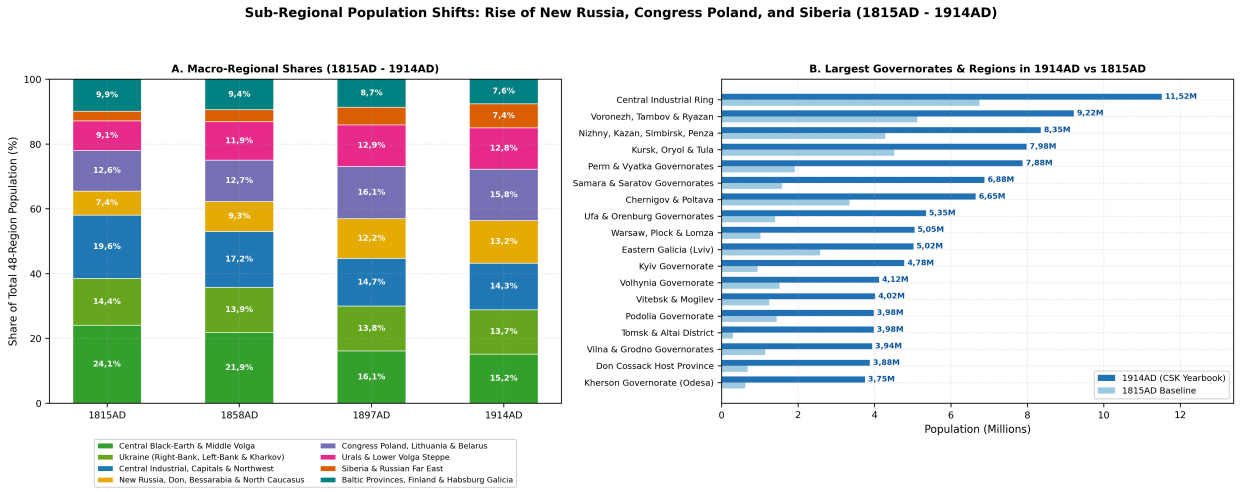


Figure 3. Trans-Siberian railway versus northern river basin growth in Siberia (Panel A) and wartime population shifts from 1914AD to 1917AD (Panel B).

Siberia and the Far East

Across the 13.354.849 km2 expanse of Siberia and the Russian Far East (Regions 41-48), aggregate population expanded more than sevenfold from 1,72M in 1815AD to 3,08M in 1858AD, 6,68M in 1897AD, 12,47M in 1914AD and 12,88M in 1917AD [27][28][29][89]. As shown in Figure 3A and Table 6, this colonisation was divided between the Trans-Siberian Railway and Priamurye agricultural corridors (Regions 41, 43, 45 and 48) and the northern riverine, gold-mining and indigenous *yasak* basins (Regions 42, 44, 46 and 47).

Construction of the Trans-Siberian Railway (1891-1916AD), initiated simultaneously at Vladivostok and Chelyabinsk in 1891AD, transformed peasant settlement across the southern steppes and forest-steppe belt (Regions 41, 43 and 45). Reinforced after 1906AD by Prime Minister P. A. Stolypin's Resettlement Administration (*Pereselencheskoe upravlenie*, offering cheap *khutor*/*otrub* land credits, agronomic depots and subsidised fourth-class rail cars), peasant migration across the Urals exceeded 5M gross (>3,5M net) settlers between 1896AD and 1914AD, peaking in 1907-1909AD (665k-759k migrants per year) [27][28][90][91]. The Tomsk railway trunk and Altai Imperial Cabinet lands (Region 43) formed the primary Stolypin destination in the Empire, surging nearly fourteenfold from 300k (1815AD) to 1,93M (1897AD), 3,98M (1914AD) and 4,18M (1917AD) as settlers poured onto fertile chernozem leased from the Tsar's Cabinet around Barnaul (1k to 61k), Biysk (5k) and the Ob bridge rail boomtown of Novonikolaevsk/Novosibirsk (founded 1893AD; 7,8k in 1897AD to 85k in 1914AD to 107k in 1917AD), overtaking the older university seat of Tomsk (7k) [90][92]. Similarly, the Southern Tobolsk and Omsk Trans-Siberian belt (Region 41) grew from 545k (1815AD) to 1,74M (1897AD) and 3,18M (1914AD, led by Omsk at 37,4k to 135,8k and the Danish-cooperative butter hub of Kurgan at 38,5k) [93][94][95], while the Central Trans-Siberian corridor (Region 45) rose from 210k to 1,54M (Krasnoyarsk 87,5k and Irkutsk 129,7k) [96].

By contrast, the northern river basins and southern mountain borderlands bypassed by the main rail line grew much more slowly (Regions 42, 44, 46 and 47). In the Ob-Irtysh river north (Region 42, covering Tobolsk, Berezov, Surgut, Obdorsk and Narym), population increased modestly from 160k to 375k and 505k, with the old guberniya capital of Tobolsk stagnating at 20,4k to 24,5k once bypassed 250 km to the

south by the railway. The Altai-Sayan highlands and Uriankhai (Region 44) rose from 125k to 565k (1914AD), incorporating Minusinsk settlers, Altai pastoralists [97] and the Uriankhai Krai (Tuva) placed under formal Imperial Russian protectorate in April 1914AD with its new administrative post at Belotsarsk (Kyzyl). In the Yenisei-Turukhansk polar north and Lena goldfields (Region 46, rising from 68k to 195k and 270k), the stagnating river town of Yeniseysk (5k to 11,9k) stood alongside the remote Vitim-Olekma placer camps around Bodaibo (8k), where troops shot >200 striking Lena Goldfields (Lenzoloto) miners on 4 April 1912AD. Farther east, Transbaikal and Yakutsk Oblasts (Region 47, growing from 278k to 942k and 1,29M) united Buryat and Sakha (*Yakut*) pastoralists (~225k Yakuts and ~180k Transbaikal Buryats in 1897AD), Nerchinsk *katorga* mines, Yakutsk (8k) and the railway junction of Chita (5k to 79,2k) [89][98].

In the Russian Far East, the Priamurye Governor-Generalship (Region 48, comprising Amur, Primorskaya and Sakhalin across 1.043.120 km2) was acquired from Qing China via Governor-General N. N. Muravyov-Amursky's Treaty of Aigun (1858AD) and N. P. Ignatyev's Convention of Peking (1860AD), and its population rose nearly fortyfold from 30k indigenous Tungusic/Nivkh inhabitants (1815AD) and 55k (1858AD) to 372k (1897AD) and 1,14M (1914AD, reaching 1,15M in 1917AD) [30][99]. Growth was driven by Amur and Ussuri Cossacks and >250k Ukrainian peasants from Poltava, Chernigov and Kyiv sailing via Odessa Volunteer Fleet (*Dobroflot*) steamers and the Chinese Eastern (1903AD) and Amur (1916AD) Railways into the Ussuri "Green Wedge" (*Zelenyy Klyn* around Nikolsk-Ussuriysky, 47,4k), Vladivostok (5k to 108k as a wartime Allied supply port), Blagoveshchensk (5k) and Khabarovsk (3k). On Sakhalin, secured wholly in exchange for the Kurils under the 1875AD Treaty of Saint Petersburg (1k penal exiles and guards in 1897AD centred on Aleksandrovsky Post), defeat in the Russo-Japanese War (1904-1905AD) forced the cession of Southern Sakhalin (Karafuto, south of 50°N) under the September 1905AD Treaty of Portsmouth [30].

Region (41-48)	1815AD	1850AD	1858AD	1870AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
41. West Siberian Trans-Siberian Belt: Southern Tobolsk	545k	880k	990k	1,18M	1,74M	2,78M	3,18M	3,32M
42. Ob-Irtysh River Trail & Polar Tundra: Tobolsk, Surgut, Berezov & Narym	160k	220k	240k	275k	375k	465k	505k	520k
43. Tomsk Railway Trunk	300k	580k	690k	920k	1,93M	3,42M	3,98M	4,18M
44. Altai-Sayan Highlands: Gorny Altai, Minusinsk & Uriankhai Protectorate	125k	185k	205k	240k	330k	495k	565k	575k
45. Central Siberian Trans-Siberian Corridor: Achinsk-Krasnoyarsk-Kansk & Irkutsk	210k	330k	375k	460k	795k	1,32M	1,54M	1,56M
46. Yenisei-Turukhansk Polar North & Bodaibo Lena Goldfields	68k	98k	110k	135k	195k	245k	270k	265k
47. Transbaikal Oblast	278k	380k	415k	510k	942k	1,18M	1,29M	1,3M
48. Priamurye Gov.-Gen.: Amur, Primorskaya	30k	45k	55k	95k	372k	920k	1,14M	1,15M

Table 6. Population series across the eight Siberian and Far Eastern regions, contrasting rail corridors and northern river basins (1815AD - 1917AD).

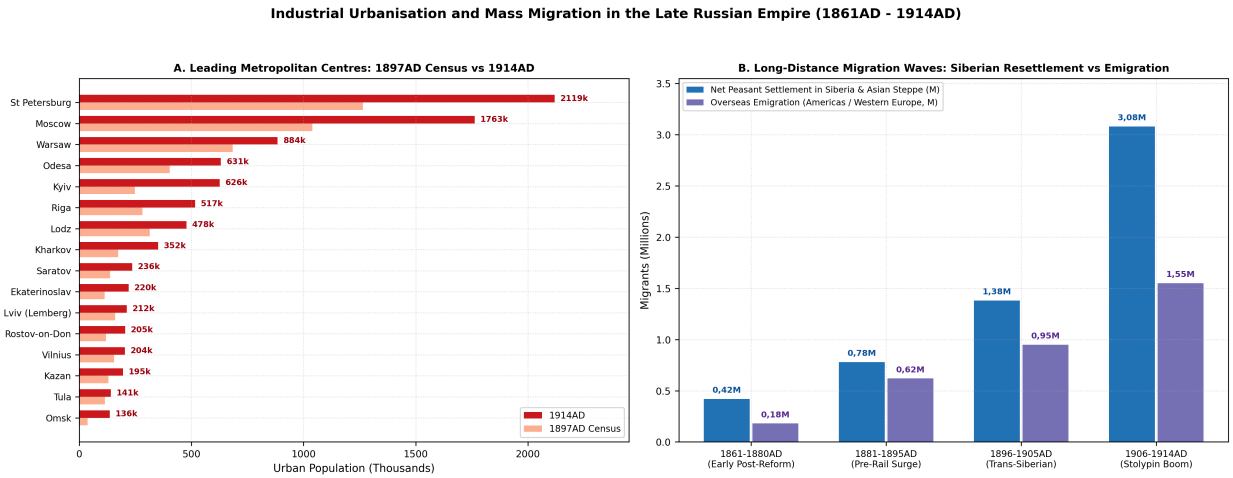


Figure 4. Largest Late Imperial cities in 1897AD and 1914AD (Panel A) and urban growth trajectories of major industrial, port and rail hubs (1815AD - 1917AD, Panel B).

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